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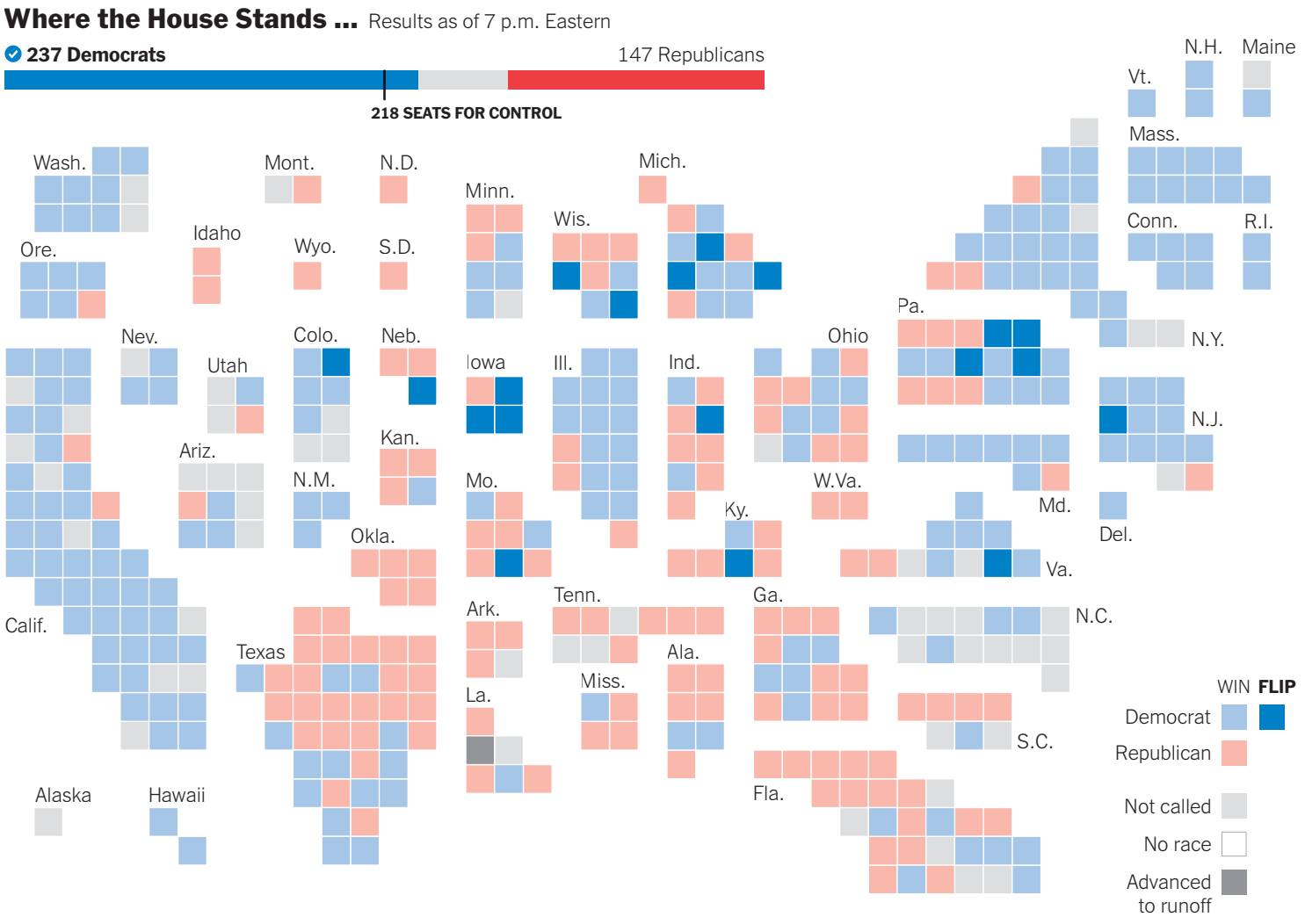
The New York Times

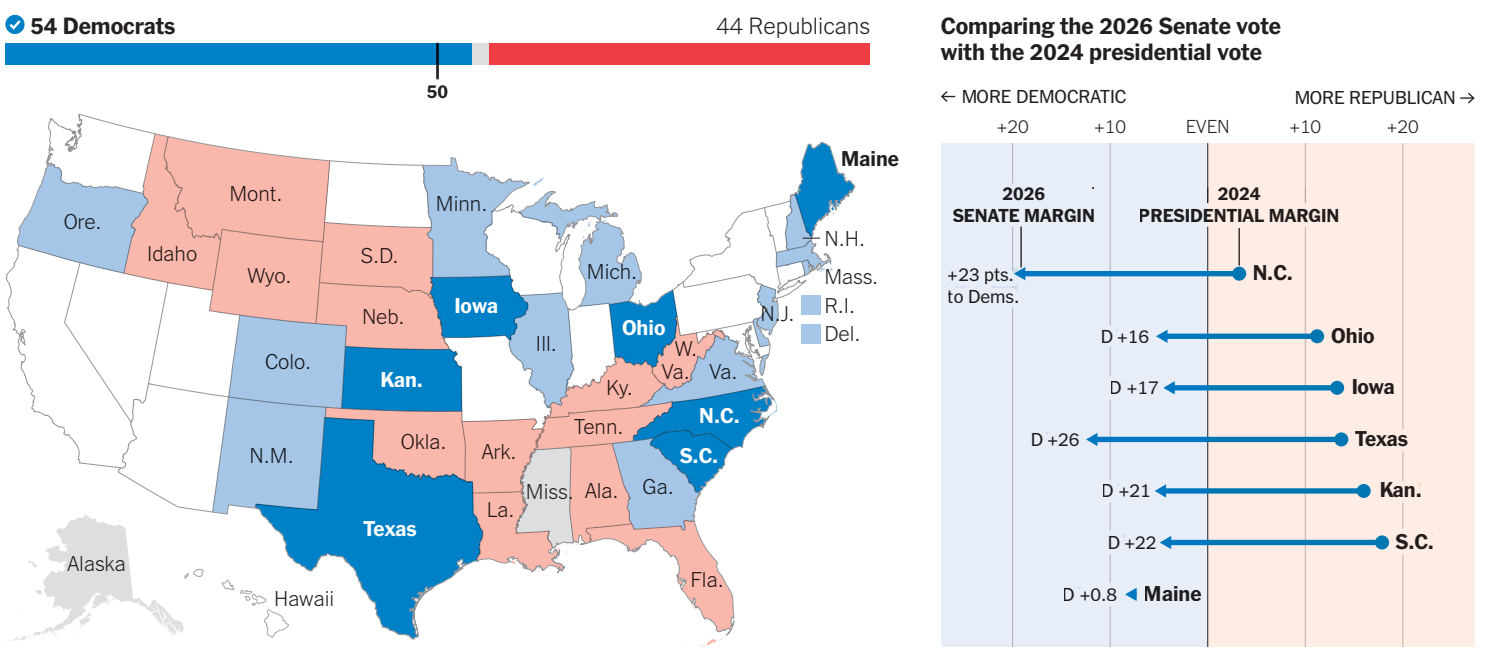
THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy and breezy with afternoon showers, high 70. **Tonight,** overcast and warm with showers, low 62. **Tomorrow,** cloudy with rain, high 67. Weather map, Page B10.

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A FORCEFUL REBUKE

Democrats Sweep Congress, Delivering Blow to Republicans





Notes: The tally of seats won by each party includes uncalled races in which all candidates are of the same party. Party seat totals include third-party candidates who caucus with Democrats. Flips have not been shaded in states where districts have been redrawn since 2024.

THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Signal Trump's Era Is Starting Its Twilight

By PETER BAKER

President Trump implored voters over the course of the midterm campaign to "pretend I'm on the ballot." He said it not once, not twice, but 47 times this fall.

And voters did — just not the way he hoped.

NEWS ANALYSIS

The Democratic wave in the congressional elections on Tuesday amounted to a stinging rebuke of a deeply unpopular president after more than a decade in which he has dominated the national stage. More than any of his predecessors, Mr. Trump deliberately made the midterm contest a referendum on himself, only to pay the price.

The electoral backlash extended even into deep red states and indicated that Mr. Trump has lost his hold over the coalition that lifted him to the White House twice. Frustrated by high gas prices, an intractable war with Iran and allegations of flagrant profiteering by Mr. Trump and members of his circle, voters who previously took a chance on an outsider promising change either rejected his party or stayed home.

As of Wednesday, the Democratic margin of victory in the overall national vote for House seats was expected to be 13 percentage points, the largest that either party has lodged in a congressional election since at least 1976, according to estimates by The New York Times. It would dwarf even the margins that the Republicans won in their two big landslide victories of modern times when they defeated congressional Democrats when Bill Clinton held the White House in 1994 and Barack Obama was president in 2010.

Thanks to redistricting, that margin may not translate into as many seats as the winners gained in those watershed years. Gerrymandered House districts leave far fewer seats available for poaching by the other party

Continued on Page A13

Vance Cites War — Johnson to Step Back

By CATIE EDMONDSON and MICHAEL LEVENSON

WASHINGTON — Democrats promised on Wednesday to use their sweeping congressional majorities to check and investigate President Trump, while Republicans started pointing fingers after a devastating midterm wipeout left their party searching for a path forward in a drastically reordered Washington.

Democrats were on track to secure at least a 50-seat majority in the House and had captured solid control of the Senate after notching seismic victories that extended deep into Republican territory and promised to shift the balance of power for Mr. Trump's final two years in office.

Triumphant as the scale of their wins came into sharper focus, Democrats vowed to take quick action to challenge Mr. Trump and to aggressively investigate him and his administration.

The party flipped Senate seats in Maine, Iowa, Kansas, Ohio, North Carolina, South Carolina and even Texas, according to The Associated Press. Ballots were still being counted in Alaska's contentious Senate race and in the unlikely battleground of Mississippi, where fewer than 70 votes separated the two candidates as of Wednesday afternoon.

Representative Hakeem Jeffries, Democrat of New York, who is expected to become the next House speaker, predicted that Democrats would win at least 255 seats in the 435-seat House. "It wasn't a blue wave; it was an American tsunami," he said.

Senator Chuck Schumer of New York, the Democratic leader and a fellow Brooklynite, called it "a generational remake of the Senate majority."

Democrats surged in crucial House battlegrounds and beyond, picking off Republicans who had not expected competitive races in conservative-leaning seats from Indiana to Missouri to Alabama.

They were on track to secure the largest majority in the cham-

Continued on Page A12

Seismic Change As Texas Breaks Grasp of G.O.P.

By J. DAVID GOODMAN and LAUREN McGAUGHY

AUSTIN, Texas — Texas may never be the same.

Democrats shattered the 32-year-long Republican grip on statewide offices in what had been, until Tuesday, the nation's most populous conservative state.

James Talarico's victory over Ken Paxton, a scandal-scarred Republican candidate, in the U.S. Senate race was only the beginning of a series of seismic victories for Democrats on Tuesday in Texas.

Gina Hinojosa made history with her defeat of Gov. Greg Abbott, the third-term governor and political powerhouse who, just a few months ago, appeared to have a lock on winning a record fourth term. She becomes Texas's first Hispanic governor.

In one night, the state was transformed.

"Talarico is a symbol. Gina is an earthquake," said Garry Mauro, a

Continued on Page A17

The Senate Seats That Turned Blue

Democrats flipped at least seven seats in the Senate to retake control of the chamber with the party's biggest majority since 2014. Races in Alaska and Mississippi remained too close to call. Page A11.



IOWA
Josh Turek
The Paralympian and state lawmaker won an open seat in a red state.



KANSAS
Adam Hamilton
The centrist Democrat is the pastor of the largest church in the state.



MAINE
Troy Jackson
The former logger won against Susan Collins, the longtime incumbent.



NORTH CAROLINA
Roy Cooper
The former governor defeated the president's handpicked candidate.



OHIO
Sherrod Brown
The populist who lost his seat in 2024 will return to the chamber.



SOUTH CAROLINA
Annie Andrews
The pediatrician upset Darline Graham, who filled her brother's seat.



TEXAS
James Talarico
The state lawmaker prevailed in a bruising and costly campaign.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Congress to Dust Off Role As Check on the President

By CARL HULSE

The Democratic sweep of the House and the Senate that has upended the balance of power in Washington has also given an atrophied Congress an opportunity to reclaim its relevance and constitutional role as a check on the president after two years of Republican compliance.

Since President Trump was elected in 2024 along with G.O.P. House and Senate majorities, Republicans on Capitol Hill have defined their role mainly as empowering him and beating back Democratic resistance. That has allowed the executive branch to act with near impunity, steamrolling Congress on spending, tariffs and war powers.

Now, with Democrats set to take firm control of both chambers in a rebuke to Mr. Trump and the Republicans who ceded much of their power to him, the legislative branch is poised to reassert itself in multiple ways — notably on spending and oversight. Democrats say they are determined to investigate and push back against the president and his administration.

"We are going to bring accountability to those who have visited unprecedented corruption on this country," said Representative Hakeem Jeffries, the New York Democrat who is in line to become speaker.

On Wednesday in Washington, as the scope of Democratic victories came into sharper focus, he declared, "The days of the House of Representatives functioning like a wholly owned subsidiary of the Trump administration are over."

Senator Chuck Schumer of New York, the Democratic leader, also vowed that Democrats would bring about the end of an era: "The days of Trump's supplicant Senate are over," he said.

Despite their aggressive inten-

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Wisdom From N.F.L.'s Elders
Calais Campbell, Kirk Cousins and other players over 35 reveal how they endure in an unforgiving league. PAGE B6

Tumult Over Time Zones
A shift in Canada will lead to additional complications for the Canucks and other N.H.L. teams. PAGE B9



INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Iranian Calls for Nuclear Arms
Some clerics and officials say that the country must rebuild deterrence by dropping its longstanding pledge not to build a nuclear bomb. PAGE A7

U.S. Aided Venezuelan Attack
American intelligence recently helped direct lethal drone strikes on Colombian rebels involved in drug trafficking near the border, officials said. PAGE A5

Addressing Israeli Deadlock
President Isaac Herzog, who began party meetings, is a savvy mediator whose skills could be vital after an unsettled vote. News Analysis. PAGE A8

BUSINESS B1-5

A.I. Scrutiny on the Horizon
After years of little A.I. oversight, voters rejected data centers and backed Democrats who supported regulation. PAGE B1

NATIONAL A10-19

A Win for 'Taxing the Rich'
An appeals court ruled the Mamdani administration can roll out a tax on second homes in New York. PAGE A19

OBITUARIES A22

He Captured a 1960 Massacre
Ian Berry, the only photographer that day in Sharpeville, South Africa, was 92.

ARTS C1-6

Fight Over Kinky Art's Legacy
A man who helped Tom of Finland elevate gay erotica is clashing with a foundation that protects his work. PAGE C1

Lil Baby's Point of View
Taking on new challenges, the superstar rapper from Atlanta still possesses that same hunger to dominate. PAGE C1



THURSDAY STYLES D1-8

Carrying an 'It' Bag Further
Starting with a leather link tote, SC103's designers have captured a desire for garments that show their craft. PAGE D6

Dressing Their New Selves
A wardrobe overhaul has been on the agenda for many people taking GLP-1 weight-loss medications. PAGE D1

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